

- `$ wget <URL of the file>`
- ◆ To download a list of files, put them in a text file and point Wget to this file:
- `$ wget -i /path/to/list_of_files.txt`
- ◆ To enable Wget to resume a download if it gets interrupted, use:
- `$ wget -c <URL of the file>`

3. Rsync

An extremely handy tool for synchronising two or more directories, Rsync is typically used for backing up extremely large datasets due to its ability to perform incremental file transfers. Using a de-duplication algorithm, Rsync only copies over parts of a file that have changed, thus lowering transfer times and bandwidth requirements – making it an ideal choice for synchronising directories over a network. Rsync is usually installed by default on most systems, and hence a part of the default repositories of all major Linux distributions.

Tips for usage:

- `$ rsync -avzhP <source directory> <destination directory>`

Both, the source and the destination can be either local folders or remote locations (using the ‘username@hostname:/path/to/’ folder format).

Here’s a brief description of the flags used in the above command:

- a: Archive mode, which copies recursively and preserves symbolic links, hard links, permissions and modification times.
- v: Verbose mode, where all logs are printed to the user’s terminal window.
- z: Enables compression of files, which is especially valuable when copying files over a network.
- h: Prints all data sizes in a human readable format (e.g. KB or MB instead of bytes).
- P: The purpose of this flag is two-fold – to give you a progress bar that helps visualise your transfers and to resume the transfers if any network connectivity issues are experienced.

4. MD5Sum

A checksum is a unique alpha-numeric value computed by running an algorithm over a set of data. Checksums are repeatable, meaning the same data will always generate the same checksum value. The MD5sum is a 128-